

25 Years of ModRef: A Retrospective Quiz

19/07/2026 - Lisbon

About this document

This document contains the questions and answers of the quiz that was held at ModRef '26 in Lisbon. The interactive Wooclap slides have been replaced with plain slides that show directly both the question and the answers.

Q1. Which number of ModRef edition are we celebrating this year?

1. 15

2. 30

3. 25

4. 3.14159

ModRef Series

2002

2003

2004

2005

2006

2007

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2019

2020

2021

2022

2023

2024

2025

Q2. Who chaired the first edition of ModRef?

1. **Alan Frisch**
2. Brahim Hnich
3. Ian Miguel
4. Steve Prestwich

Q3. Today, ModRef stands for Workshop on Constraint Modelling and Reformulation. What was the name of the first edition of ModRef?

- 1. The First International Workshop on Reformulating Constraint Satisfaction Problems**
2. The First International Workshop on Modelling and Problem Formulation
3. The First International Workshop on Constraint Problem Reformulation
4. The First International Workshop on Modelling and Solving Problems with Constraints

Antecedents of ModRef

First edition of ModRef series:

- The First International Workshop on Reformulating Constraint Satisfaction Problems
Ithaca, USA, 2002

Other related workshops preceded ModRef:

- [CP 2001](#): Modelling and Problem Formulation
- [CP 1998](#): Constraint Problem Reformulation
- [ECAI 00](#), [IJCAI 01](#), [ECAI 02](#): Modelling and Solving Problems with Constraints

Source: <https://www-users.york.ac.uk/~af9/ModRef/>

ModRef Series

2002
Ithaca, USA

2008

2014

2020

2003

2009

2015

2021

2004

2010

2016

2022

2005

2011

2017

2023

2006

2012

2018

2024

2007

2013

2019

2025

Q4. Which of these have not been a name of ModRef?

1. International Workshop on Modelling and Reformulating Constraint Satisfaction Problems
2. International Workshop on Constraint Modelling and Reformulation
3. International Workshop on Reformulating Constraint Satisfaction Problems
4. **International Workshop on Modelling and Reformulation**

ModRef Series

2002

Ithaca, USA

2003

Kinsale, Ireland

2004

Toronto, Canada

2005

Sitges, Spain

2006

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2008

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2023

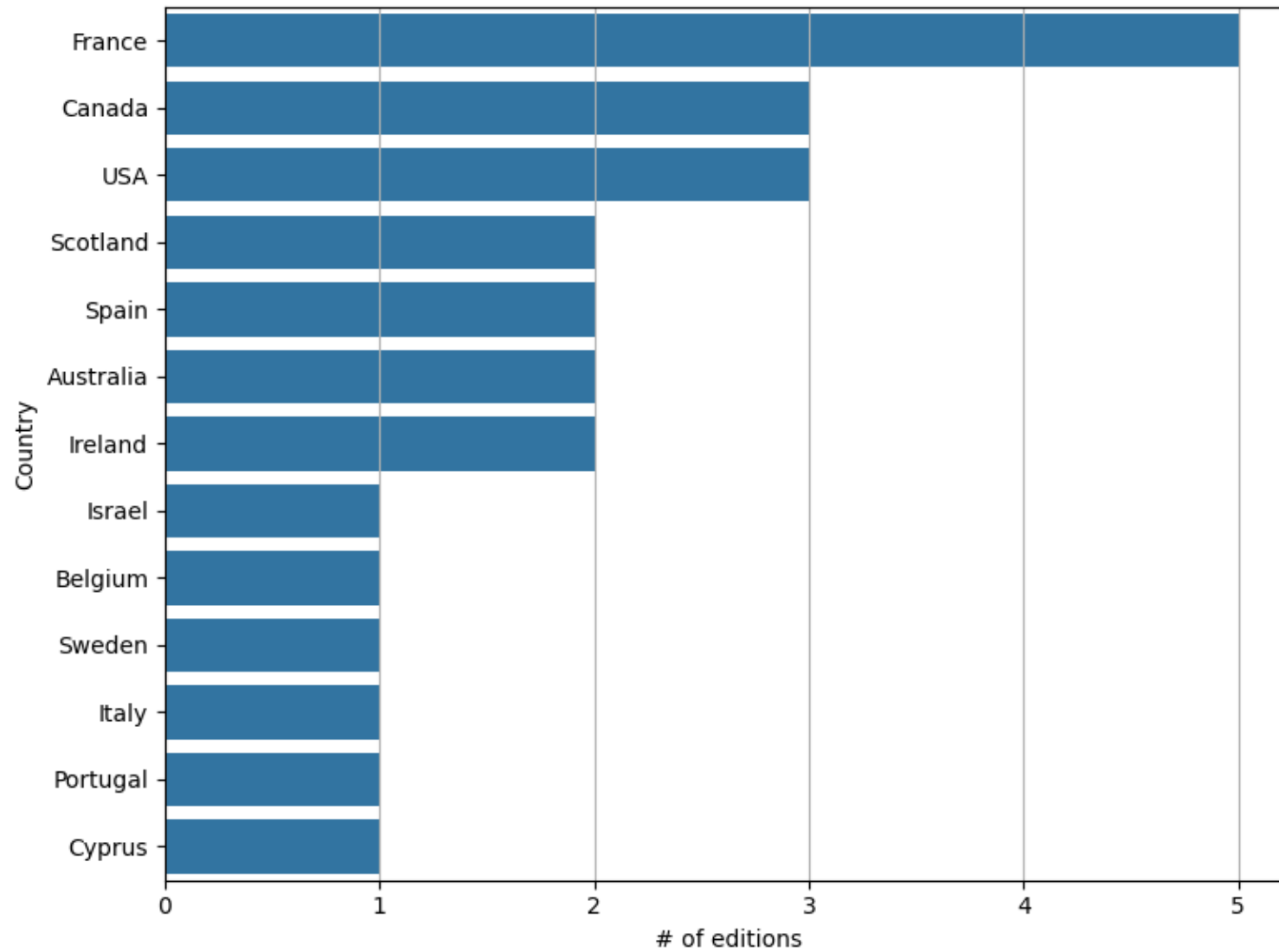
2024

2025

Q5. What country has hosted ModRef the most times?

1. Australia
2. Canada
3. **France**
4. USA

Number of times each country hosted ModRef



ModRef Series

2002

Ithaca, USA

2003

Kinsale, Ireland

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2005

Sitges, Spain

2006

Nantes, France

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2008

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Lyon, France

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2016

Toulouse, France

2017

2018

Lille, France

2019

2020

2021 (online)

Montpellier, France

2022

2023

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ModRef Series

2002

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Lille, France

2019

2020 (online)

2021 (online)

Montpellier, France

2022

2023

2024

2025

Q6. What country, besides France, hosted a virtual edition of ModRef due to the COVID-19 pandemic?

1. **Belgium**
2. Canada
3. Ireland
4. USA

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2016

Toulouse, France

2017

2018

Lille, France

2019

2020 (online)

Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium

2021 (online)

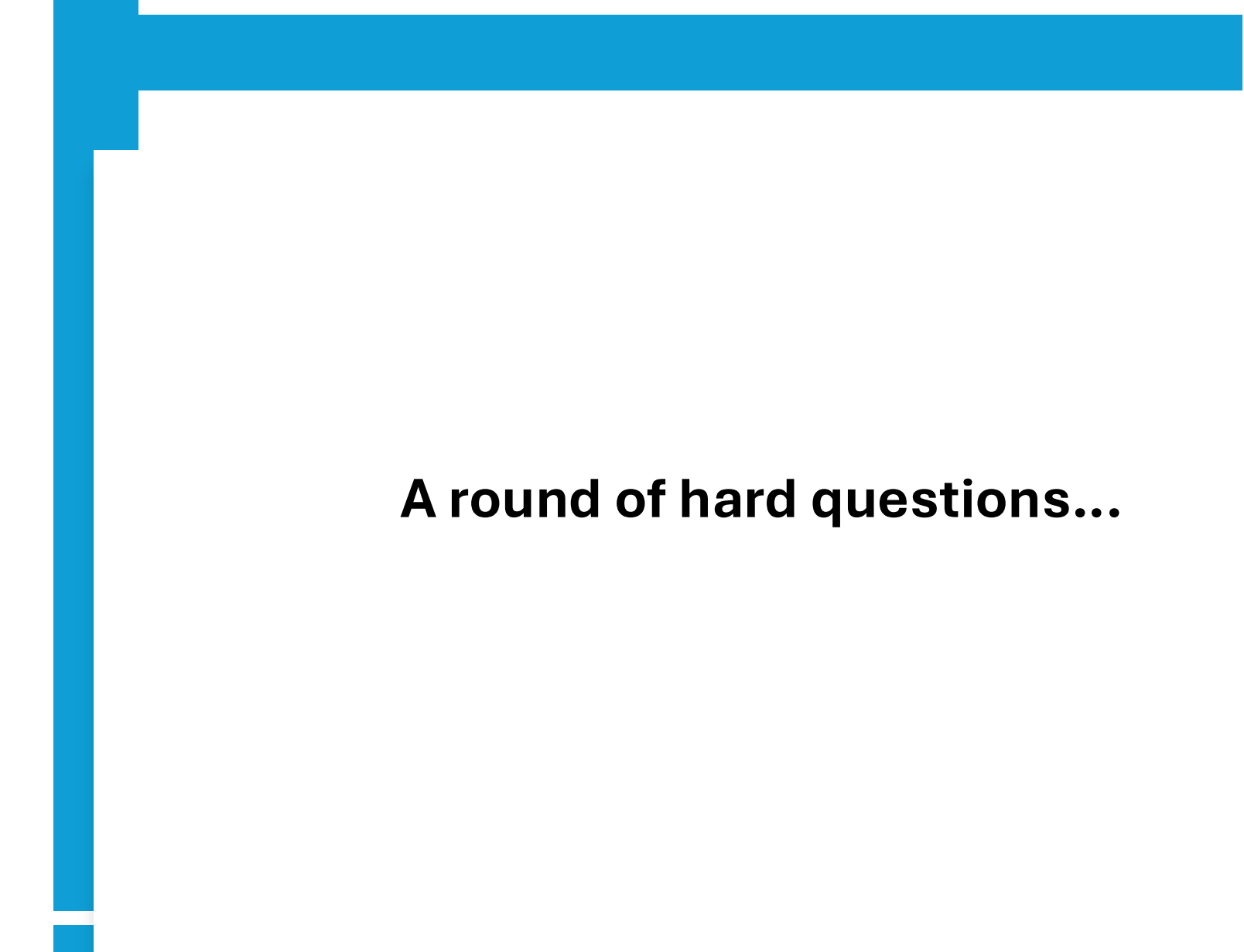
Montpellier, France

2022

2023

2024

2025



A round of hard questions...

Guess the year A

- Q7 (Clue I). Christian Bessier and Alan Frisch were authors on two ModRef papers each.
- Q8 (Clue II). The workshop was held in this building.
- Q9 (Clue III). This year the FIFA Men's World Cup was being held in a European country which has never hosted CP/ModRef.

Answer: 2006 (Nantes, France)



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2013

2014

Lyon, France

2015

2016

Toulouse, France

2017

2018

Lille, France

2019

2020 **(online)**

Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium

2021 **(online)**

Montpellier, France

2022

2023

2024

2025

Guess the year B

- Q10 (Clue I). The only time the word “explain / explanation / explainability” has appeared in an accepted paper in ModRef.
- Q11 (Clue II). The workshop had two invited talks, both speakers being from the same university at the time. There were also 5 accepted papers.
- Q12 (Clue III). This was the only year CP/ModRef has been held outside Europe, North America or Australia.

Answer: 2022 (Haifa, Israel)

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Lille, France

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Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium

2021 (online)

Montpellier, France

2022

Haifa, Israel

2023

2024

2025

Guess the year C

- Q13 (Clue I). This workshop saw the first mention of “Minizinc” in a paper title.
- Q14 (Clue II). The host country has an Atlantic coast, and the host city is one of only 2 to host ModRef twice.
- Q15 (Clue III). The date of the workshop follows the pattern AB/BC/ABBC in the day/month/year format.

Answer: 2009 (Lisbon, Portugal)

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Lyon, France

2015

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Toulouse, France

2017

2018

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2019

2020 **(online)**

Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium

2021 **(online)**

Montpellier, France

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Haifa, Israel

2023

2024

2025

Q16. Sort the following venues increasing by year.

This slide already shows the answer.

- Provicence, USA
- Sydney, Australia
- St Andrews, Scotland
- Perugia, Italy
- Quebec City, Canada
- Uppsala, Sweden

ModRef Series

2002

Ithaca, USA

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Kinsale, Ireland

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Toronto, Canada

2005

Sitges, Spain

2006

Nantes, France

2007

Providence, USA

2008

Sydney, Australia

2009

Lisbon, Portugal

2010

St Andrews, Scotland

2011

Perugia, Italy

2012

Quebec City, Canada

2013

Uppsala, Sweden

2014

Lyon, France

2015

2016

Toulouse, France

2017

2018

Lille, France

2019

2020 (online)

Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium

2021 (online)

Montpellier, France

2022

Haifa, Israel

2023

2024

2025

Q17. Sort the following venues increasingy by year.

This slide already shows the answer.

- Cork, Ireland
- Melbourne, Australia
- Stamford, USA
- Toronto, Canada
- Girona, Spain
- Glasgow, Scotland

ModRef Series

2002

Ithaca, USA

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Kinsale, Ireland

2004

Toronto, Canada

2005

Sitges, Spain

2006

Nantes, France

2007

Providence, USA

2008

Sydney, Australia

2009

Lisbon, Portugal

2010

St Andrews, Scotland

2011

Perugia, Italy

2012

Quebec City, Canada

2013

Uppsala, Sweden

2014

Lyon, France

2015

Cork, Ireland

2016

Toulouse, France

2017

Melbourne, Australia

2018

Lille, France

2019

Stamford, USA

2020 (online)

Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium

2021 (online)

Montpellier, France

2022

Haifa, Israel

2023

Toronto, Canada

2024

Girona, Spain

2025

Glasgow, Scotland

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Uppsala, Sweden

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Lyon, France

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Toulouse, France

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Melbourne, Australia

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Lille, France

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Stamford, USA

2020 (online)

Louvain-la-Neuve, Belgium

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Toronto, Canada

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Girona, Spain

2025

Glasgow, Scotland

Let's review some statistics based on paper titles

Note: the answers depending on author names for the computation might contain small deviations due to undetected different versions of the name of the same author.

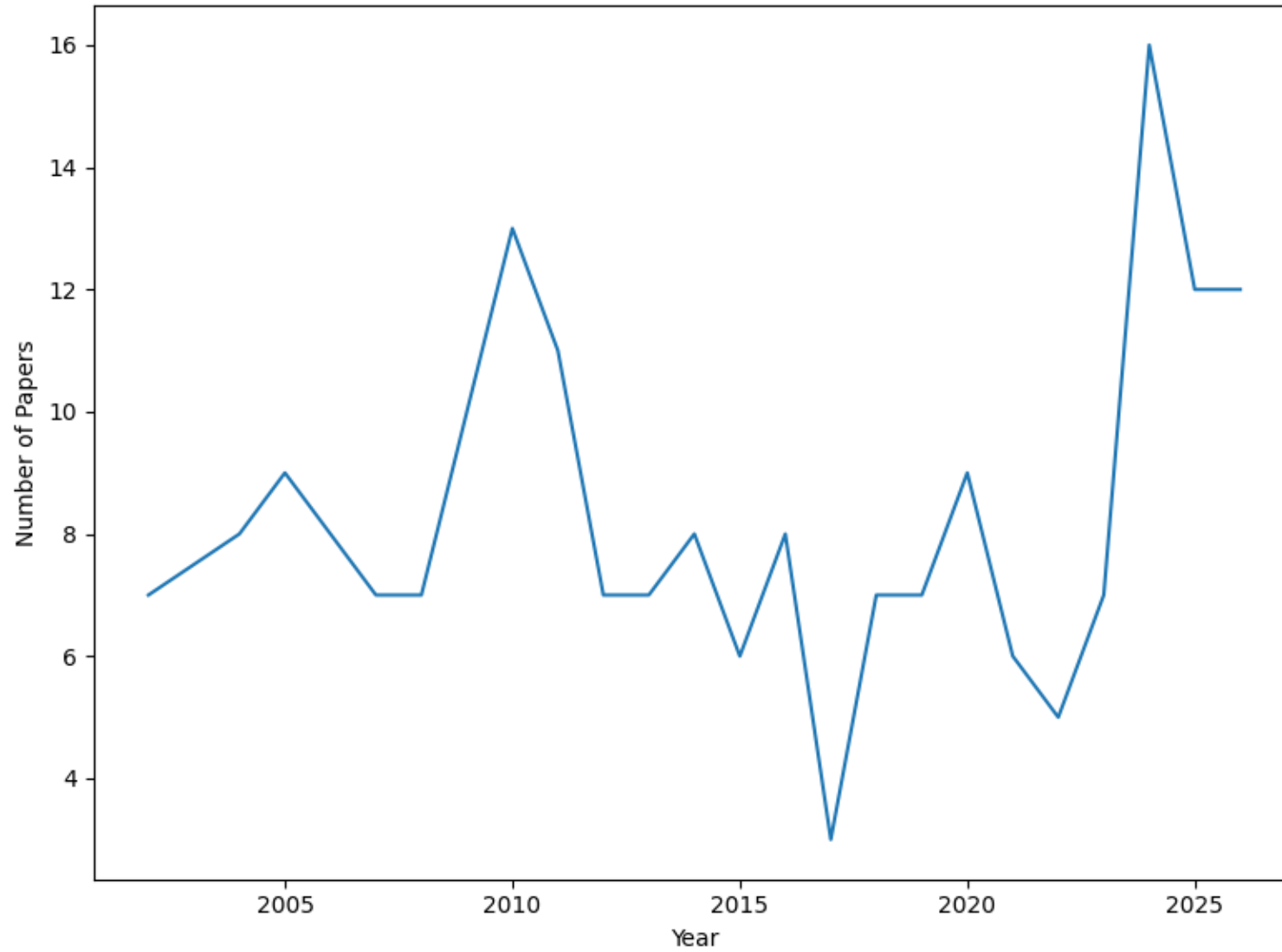
Q18. How many regular papers have been presented at ModRef?

- 1. 100
- 2. 150
- 3. **200**
- 4. 250

Q19. Which was the year with the most papers?

1. 2010 (St Andrews)
2. **2024 (Girona)**
3. 2025 (Glasgow)
4. 2026 (Lisbon)

Number of papers per year



Q20. How many distinct authors have papers accepted at ModRef?

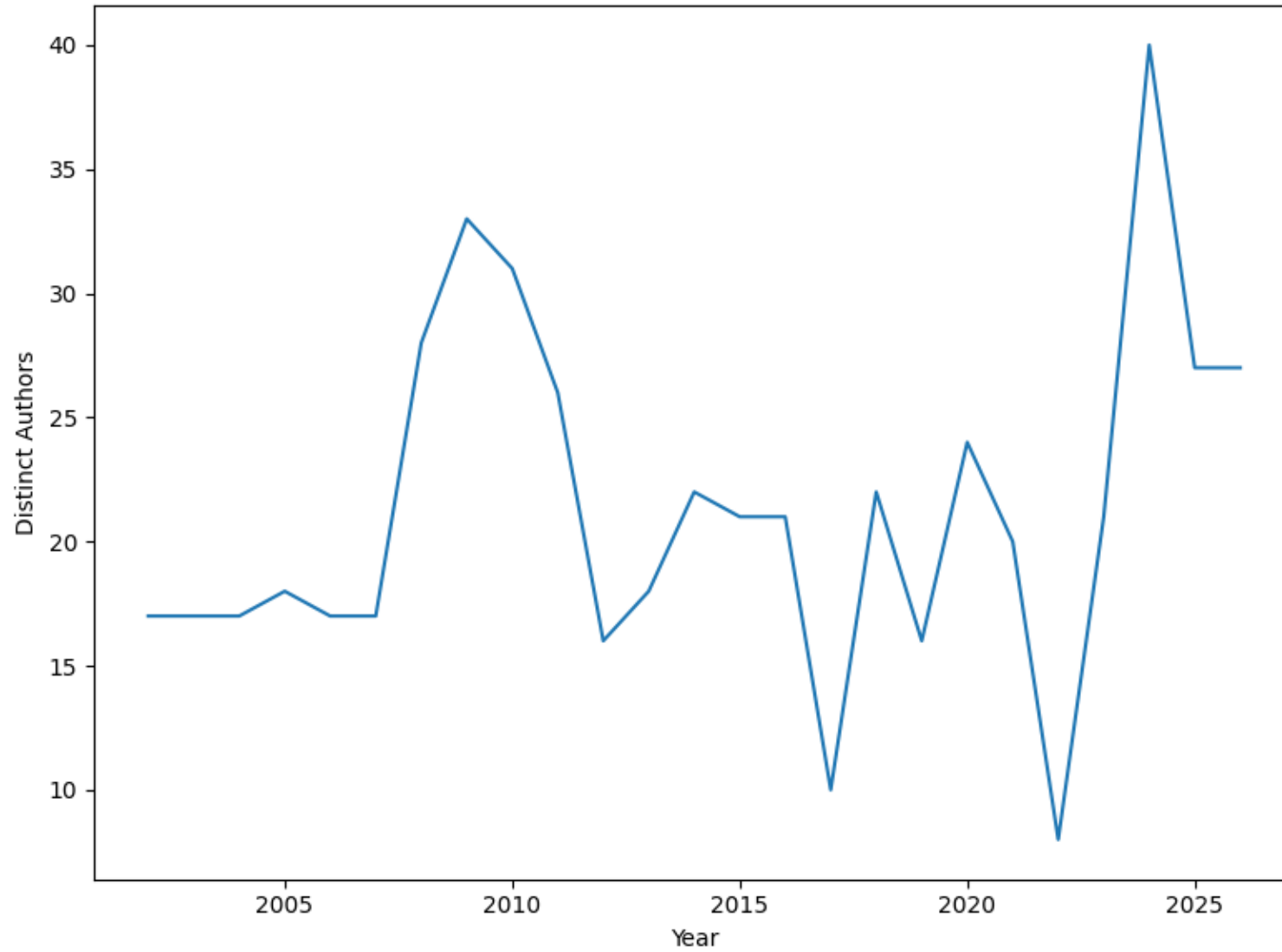
1. 237

2. 292

3. **354**

4. 418

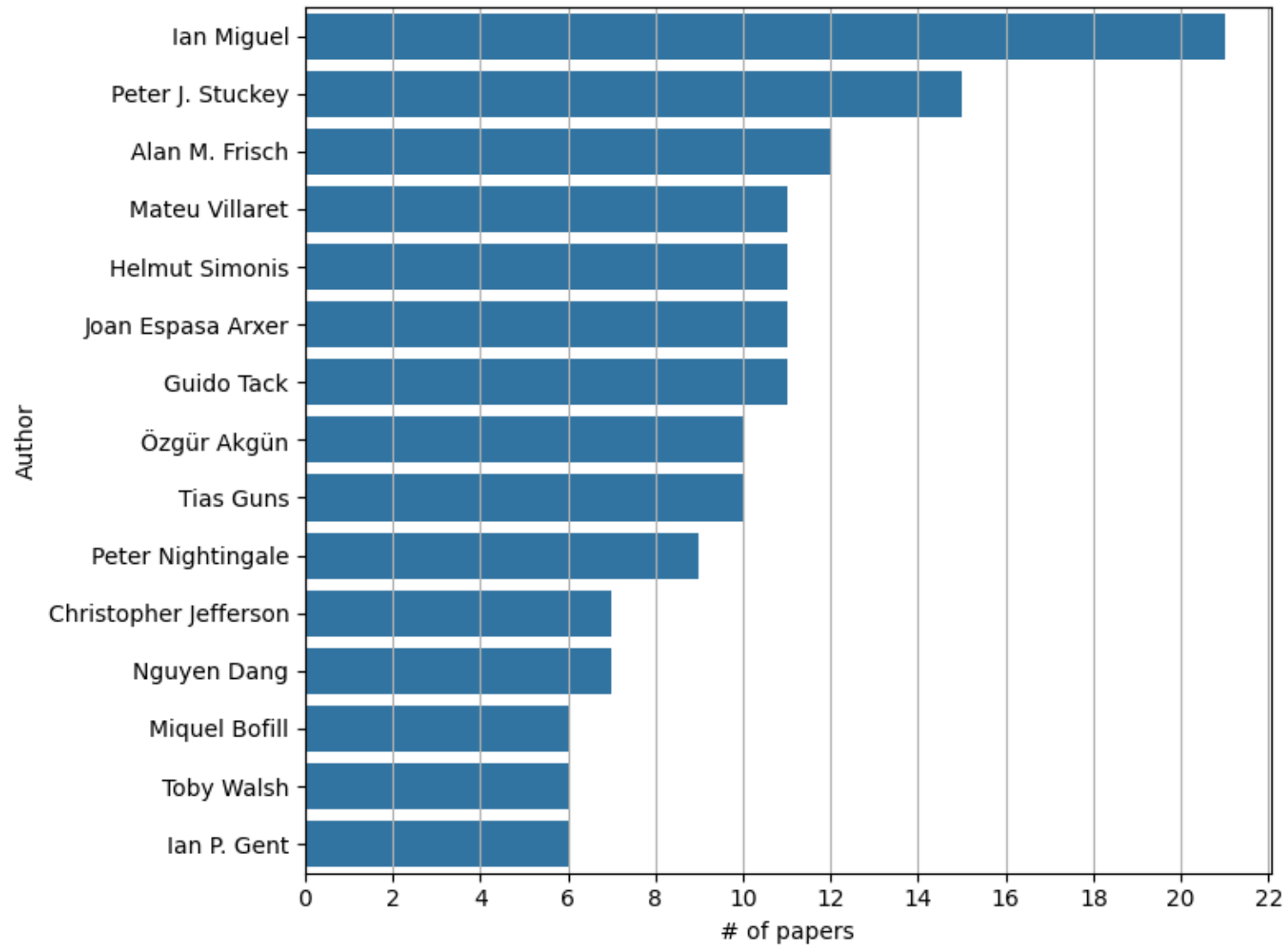
Number of distinct authors per year



Q21. Who is the author with the most regular papers in ModRef?

1. Alan M. Frisch
2. **Ian Miguel**
3. Helmut Simonis
4. Peter J. Stuckey

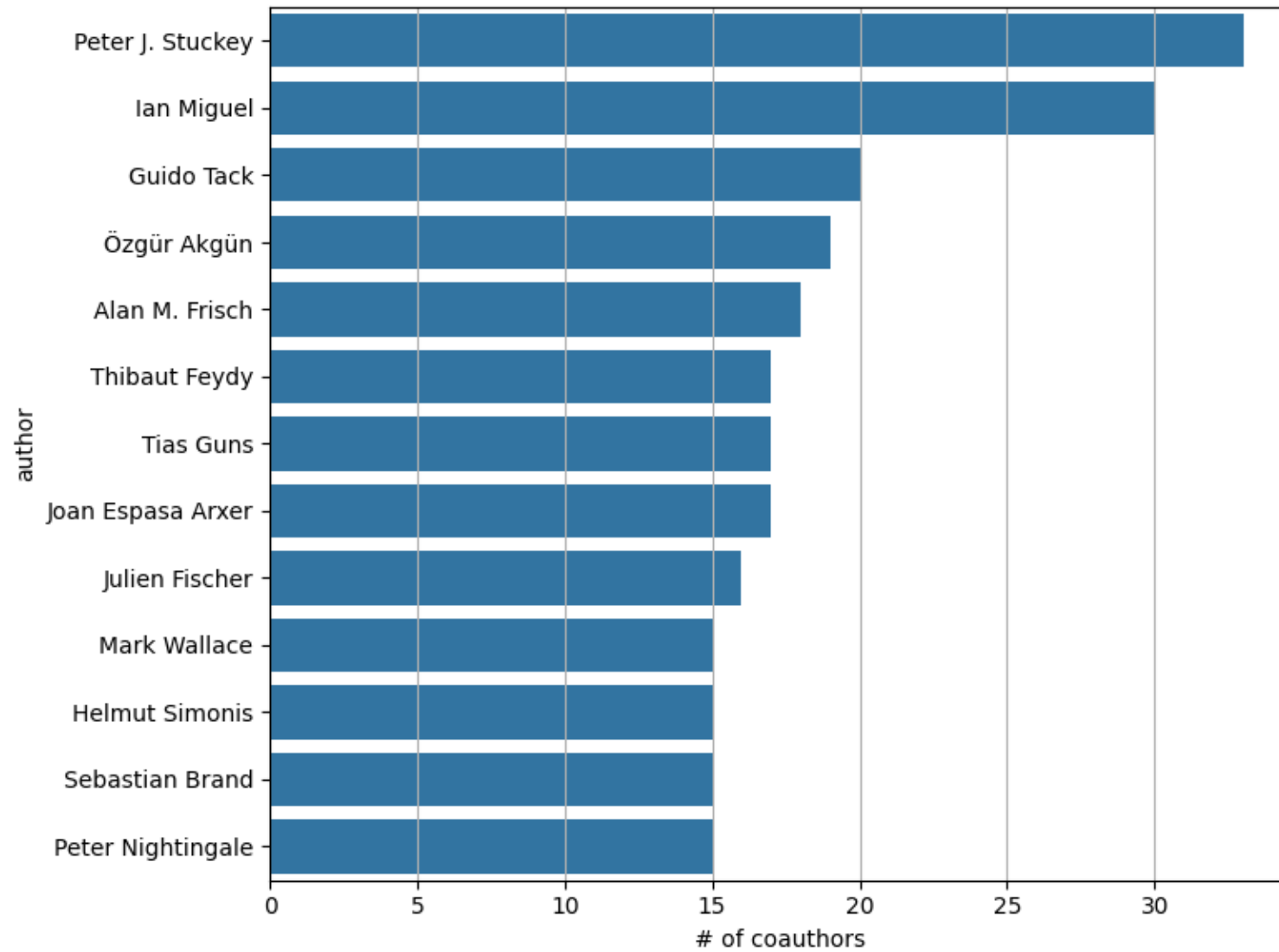
Number of papers per author (only authors with more than 5 papers)



Q22. Who is the author with the most distinct coauthors?

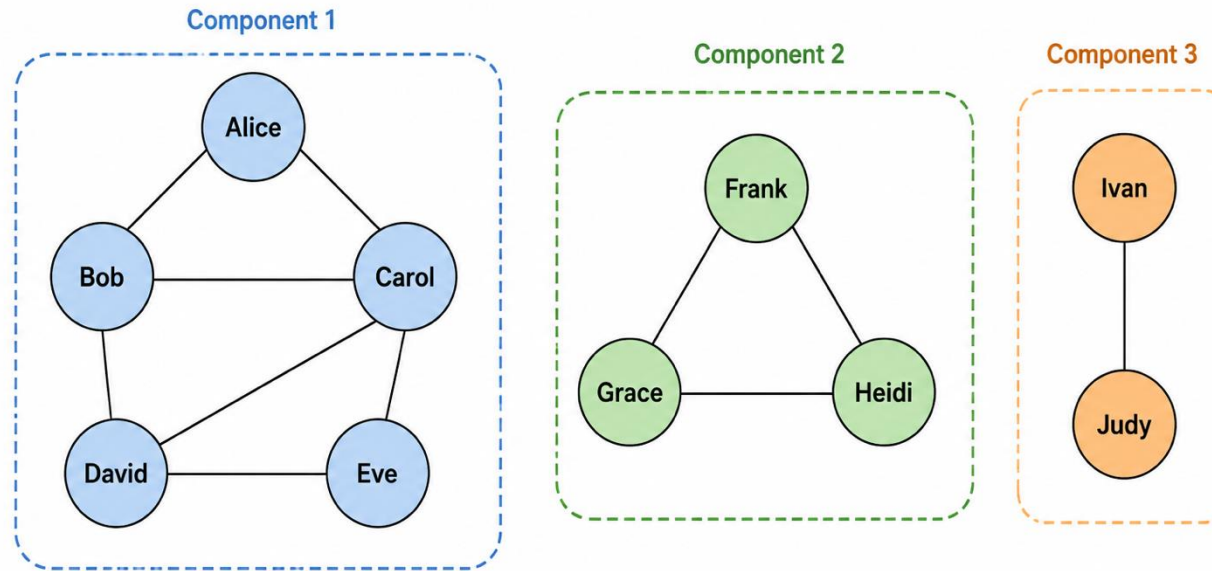
1. Özgür Akgün
2. Ian Miguel
3. **Peter J. Stuckey**
4. Guido Tack

Number of coauthors per author (at least 15 coauthors)



Are we a connected community?

Example: Graph with 10 Authors and 3 Connected Components



Some relevant data:

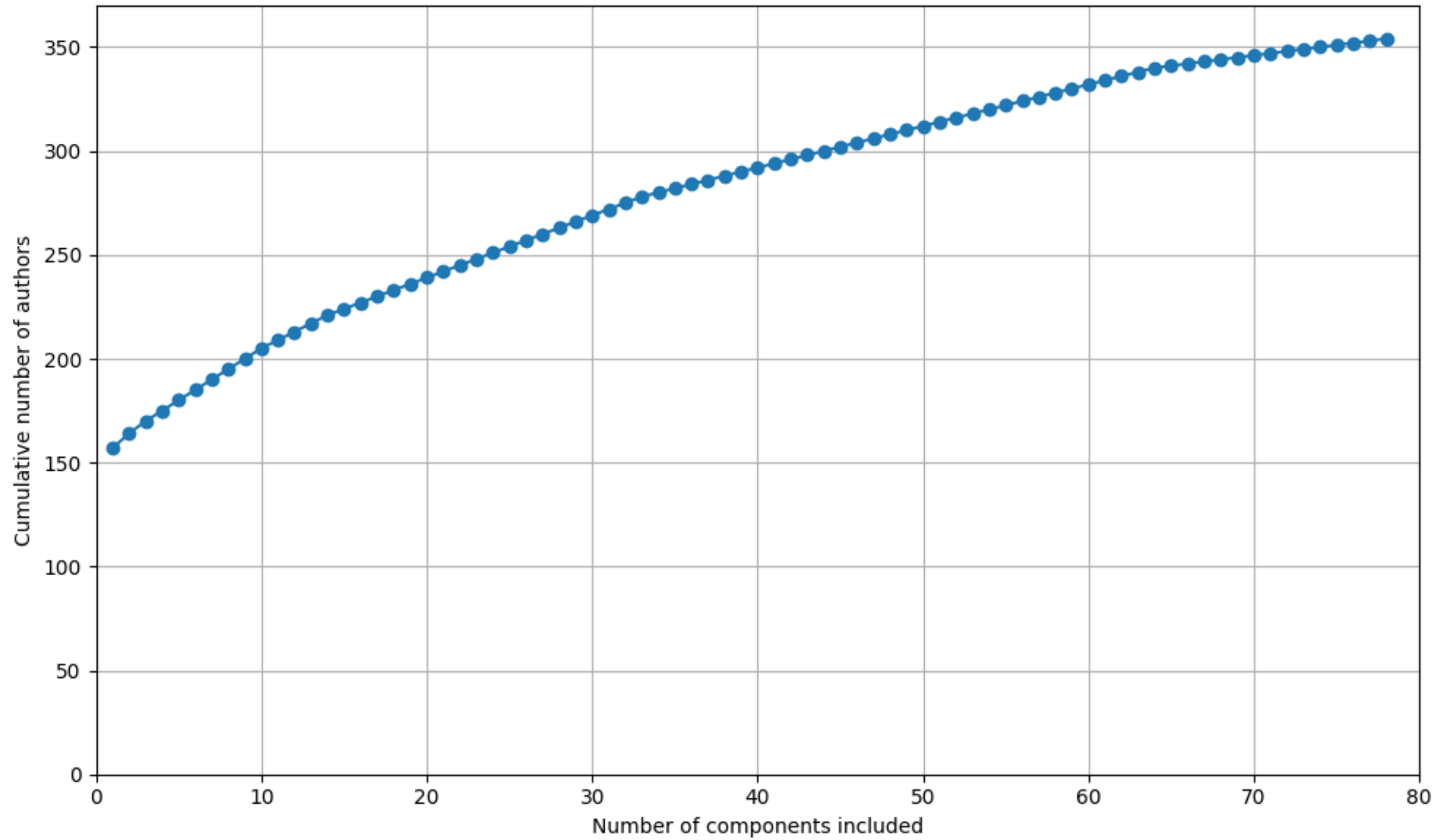
- Total number of papers: 200
- Total number of distinct authors: 354
- Number of authors with at least 2 papers: 74
- Average number of authors per paper: 2.89

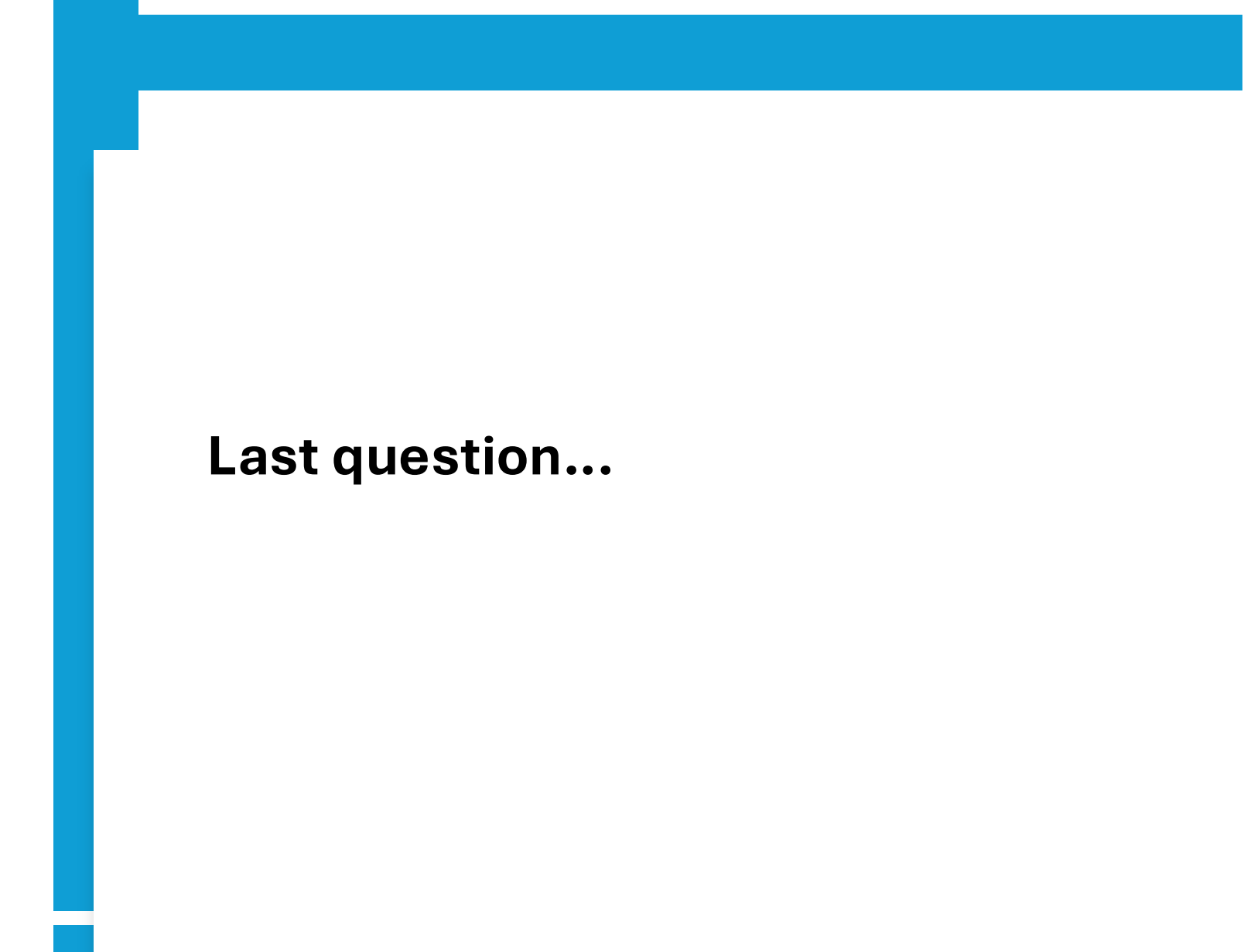
We only use ModRef papers as database.

Q23. How many connected components are there in ModRef's coauthoring graph? (+/- 15 tolerance)

Answer: 78

Cummulative distribution of component sizes





Last question...

Q24. What do you think is the most common word in a paper title?

Free answer question, there was no correct answer. The resulting word cloud after voting was:



A word cloud visualization of the most common words in paper titles. The words are arranged in a cluster, with 'Constraint' being the largest and most central word. Other words include 'Towards', 'Solving', 'Model', 'Automatic', and 'Problem'.

Towards
Constraint
Solving Model Problem
Automatic

Q25. Sort the words in descending order by number of occurrences in titles.

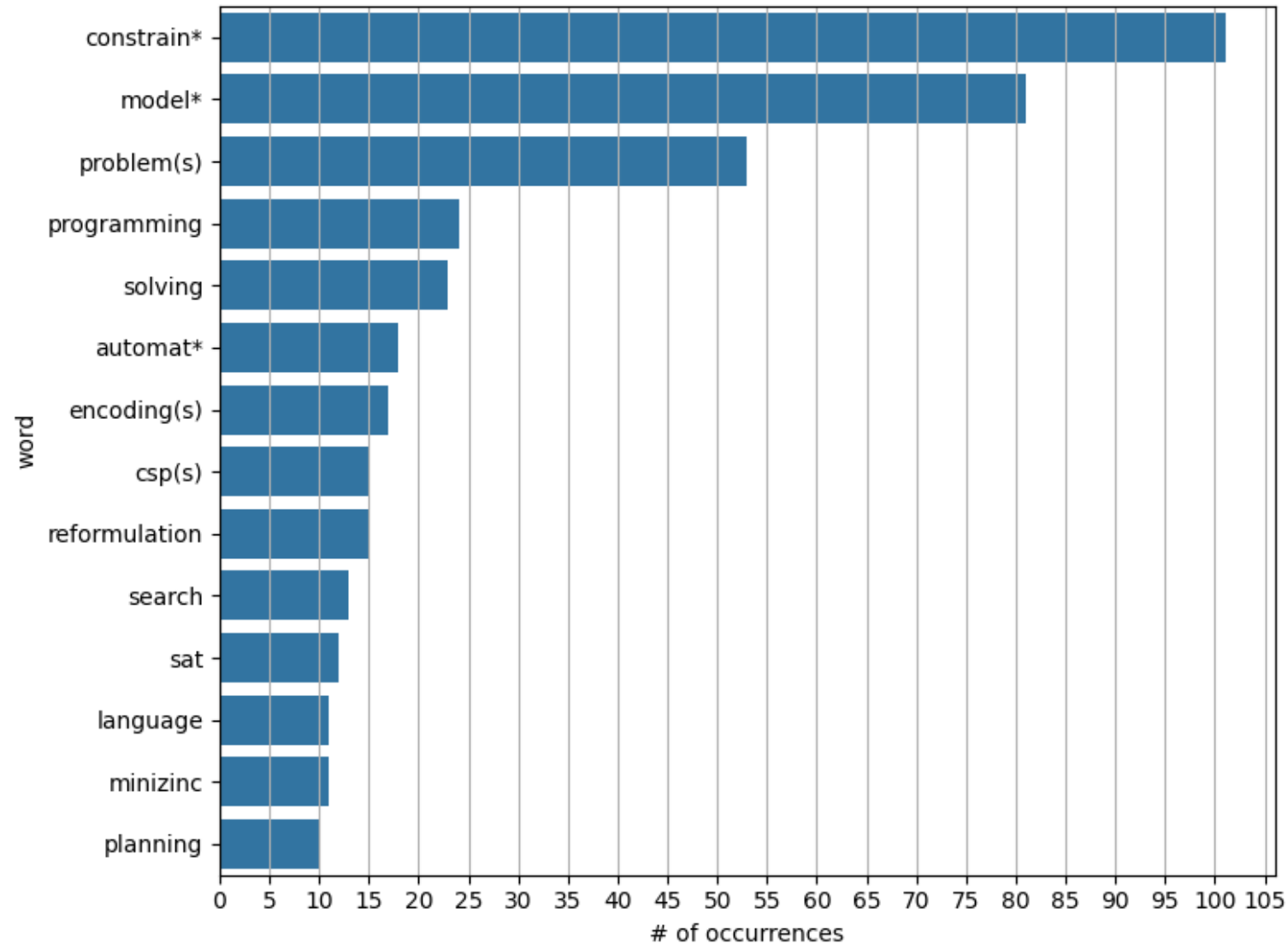
This slide already shows the answer.

- constrain*
- model*
- solving
- reformulation
- planning

Note 1: [prefix]* means word starting with prefix.

Note 2: words such as in, at, for (also towards...) were filtered away.

Ranking of word occurrences (at least 10 occurrences)



End of the quiz

The winner is...

There was a tie between Jip Dekker and Helmut Simonis, with 12 correct answers. Both won the “trophy”.



End of the quiz

Looking forward to seeing you at the 50th anniversary!